WaLeadBot — Complete User Guide

Version 1.0 · April 2026

WaLeadBot is a multi-tenant WhatsApp Business Automation and CRM platform built for Indian SMBs — clinics, real estate agencies, tuition centres, salons, and local service businesses. This guide walks through every feature from first login to advanced automation.

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1. Getting Started

WaLeadBot is accessed entirely through the web browser — no app installation is required. Navigate to your deployed URL (e.g., `https://your-project.manus.space`) to begin.

Supported browsers: Chrome, Firefox, Edge (Chromium). Safari Private Browsing and Brave Shields may block session cookies — use a standard browser window.

System requirements: Any device with a modern browser and internet connection. The dashboard is fully responsive and works on mobile phones, tablets, and desktops.

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2. OTP Login

WaLeadBot uses a passwordless OTP (One-Time Password) login system. There is no password to remember — you receive a 6-digit code each time you sign in.

Step 1 — Choose your channel

On the login page, select how you want to receive your OTP:

Channel	Description	Requires
Email	6-digit code sent to your email inbox	Resend API key configured
SMS	Code sent via SMS to your mobile number	MSG91 API key configured
WhatsApp	Code sent as a WhatsApp message	MSG91 API key configured

In development mode (before API keys are added), the OTP is printed to the server console and shown as a toast notification in the browser — useful for testing.

Step 2 — Enter your identifier

Type your email address (for Email channel) or phone number with country code (for SMS/WhatsApp, e.g. `+919876543210`).

Step 3 — Enter the OTP

A 6-digit code is sent to your chosen channel. Enter it within **10 minutes**. If the code expires, click **Resend OTP**.

First-time users

New users are automatically redirected to the **Onboarding Wizard** after their first successful login.

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3. Onboarding Wizard

The 4-step onboarding wizard guides new businesses through the essential setup. Each step can be skipped and completed later from the Settings or WhatsApp Connect pages.

Step 1 — Business Profile

Fill in your business details:

- **Business Name** (required)
- **Industry** — Clinic, Real Estate, Tuition, Salon, Restaurant, Retail, or Other

- **Phone Number** — your business contact number
- **Address** — city and full address
- **Website** — optional
- **Description** — a brief description shown in your widget

Step 2 — Connect WhatsApp

This step links your Meta WhatsApp Business account. You will need:

1. A **Meta Business Account** at business.facebook.com
2. A **WhatsApp Business App** registered under that account
3. A **Phone Number ID** and **WhatsApp Business Account ID** from the Meta Developer Console
4. A **Permanent Access Token** (not a temporary one — generate a System User token)

The webhook URL shown in this step must be entered in the Meta Developer Console under **Webhooks → WhatsApp Business Account**.

Step 3 — First FAQ

Add your first FAQ entry. This teaches the bot how to respond to common questions automatically. Example:

- **Question:** "What are your timings?"
- **Answer:** "We are open Monday to Saturday, 9 AM to 7 PM."

Step 4 — Welcome Auto-Reply

Configure the message that is automatically sent to every new customer who messages you for the first time. A live WhatsApp-style preview is shown as you type.

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4. Connecting WhatsApp

Navigate to **Platform → WhatsApp** from the sidebar to manage your WhatsApp connection at any time.

Meta Cloud API Setup

WaLeadBot uses the **Meta Cloud API** (not the unofficial WhatsApp Web API). This is the official, production-grade integration that Meta supports for businesses.

Required credentials:

Field	Where to find it
Phone Number ID	Meta Developer Console → Your App → WhatsApp → API Setup
WhatsApp Business Account ID	Meta Business Manager → Business Settings → WhatsApp Accounts
Access Token	Meta Developer Console → System Users → Generate Token
Webhook Verify Token	Any random string you choose (e.g., `my-secret-token-2026`)

Webhook setup in Meta Developer Console:

1. Go to your Meta App → **WhatsApp → Configuration**
2. Set **Callback URL** to the webhook URL shown in WaLeadBot (e.g., `https://your-project.manus.space/api/webhook/whatsapp`)
3. Set **Verify Token** to the same string you entered in WaLeadBot
4. Subscribe to the **messages** webhook field

Testing the connection

After saving your credentials, click **Test Connection** to verify the API is reachable. A green “Connected” badge will appear in the sidebar when the connection is active.

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5. Dashboard Overview

The main dashboard (`/dashboard`) provides a real-time overview of your business performance.

KPI Cards at the top show:

- Total Leads (all time)
- New Leads this month
- Active Conversations (open status)
- Total Contacts

7-day Leads Chart shows daily lead volume as a bar chart.

Quick Actions provide one-click shortcuts to the most common tasks: Add Lead, Send Broadcast, Add FAQ, and View Conversations.

Recent Activity Feed lists the last 10 events across your account — new leads, messages received, broadcasts sent, and more.

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6. Conversations Inbox

Navigate to **Core → Conversations** to view all WhatsApp conversations.

Conversation list

Conversations are listed with the contact name (or phone number), last message preview, timestamp, and status badge. The **Conversations** nav item shows a red unread badge that auto-refreshes every 30 seconds.

Status types:

Status	Meaning
Open	Active conversation requiring attention
Resolved	Marked as handled
Pending	Waiting for customer reply
Bot	Being handled by the auto-reply/FAQ bot

Message thread

Click any conversation to open the message thread. Messages are displayed in a WhatsApp-style chat bubble layout — your messages on the right (green), customer messages on the left (white).

Sending a message

Type in the message input at the bottom and press **Enter** or click **Send**. If your WhatsApp API is connected, the message is delivered via the Meta Cloud API in real time.

Updating status

Use the status dropdown in the conversation header to change the status. Marking a conversation as **Resolved** removes it from the active queue.

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7. Leads CRM

Navigate to **Core → Leads** to manage your sales pipeline.

Lead pipeline

Leads move through 6 stages:

Stage	Description
New	Just captured, not yet contacted
Contacted	Initial outreach made
Qualified	Confirmed interest and budget
Proposal	Quote or proposal sent
Won	Deal closed successfully
Lost	Deal did not close

Adding a lead manually

Click **Add Lead** and fill in:

- Name, Phone (required), Email
- Source (WhatsApp, Website, Referral, Walk-in, Other)
- Status, Estimated Value (₹)
- Tags (comma-separated labels)
- Notes

Filtering and searching

Use the **Status** dropdown and **Search** box to filter leads. The search matches against name, phone, and email.

Exporting to CSV

Click **Export CSV** to download all leads matching the current filter. The file is named `leads-{business-name}-{date}.csv` and includes all fields including tags, notes, and estimated value.

Lead scoring (AI)

The AI Intelligence page can auto-score leads based on engagement signals. Scores appear as a coloured badge on each lead card.

8. Contacts Management

Navigate to **Core → Contacts** to view and manage your WhatsApp contacts.

Contacts are created automatically when a customer messages your WhatsApp number. You can also import contacts in bulk via CSV.

Importing contacts from CSV

1. Click **Import CSV** in the top-right corner
2. **Upload** your CSV file (drag-and-drop or click to browse)
3. **Map columns** — WaLeadBot auto-detects common column names (Phone, Name, Email, Tags, Notes). Adjust the mapping if needed. The WhatsApp Number column is required.
4. **Preview** the first 5 contacts before committing
5. Click **Import** — duplicate phone numbers are updated, not duplicated

Download the template from the upload screen to get a correctly formatted sample CSV.

Editing a contact

Click **Edit** on any contact card to update the name, email, tags, notes, or block status.

Blocking a contact

Toggle **Block this contact** in the edit dialog. Blocked contacts will not receive auto-replies or be included in broadcasts.

9. Auto-Reply Rules

Navigate to **Automation → Auto-Reply** to configure keyword-triggered automatic responses.

How auto-replies work

When a customer sends a message, WaLeadBot checks it against all active auto-reply rules in priority order. The first matching rule sends its configured response.

Creating a rule

Click **Add Rule** and configure:

Field	Description
Rule Name	Internal label (e.g., “Pricing Query”)
Trigger Type	Keyword, Exact Match, Contains, Regex, or Any Message
Keywords	Comma-separated list of trigger words
Response	The message to send back
Priority	Lower number = higher priority (1 is checked first)

Trigger types explained

- **Keyword** — matches if any keyword appears anywhere in the message (case-insensitive)
- **Exact Match** — matches only if the entire message equals the keyword
- **Contains** — matches if the message contains the phrase
- **Regex** — matches using a regular expression pattern
- **Any Message** — matches every incoming message (use as a fallback/welcome rule)

Enabling/disabling rules

Use the toggle switch on each rule card to enable or disable it without deleting it.

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10. FAQ Bot

Navigate to **Automation → FAQ Bot** to manage your question-and-answer knowledge base.

How the FAQ bot works

When a customer message does not match any auto-reply rule, the FAQ bot checks if the message is semantically similar to any FAQ question using keyword matching. If a match is found, the answer is sent automatically.

Adding a FAQ entry

Click **Add FAQ** and enter:

- **Question** — the question as a customer would ask it
- **Answer** — the response to send
- **Keywords** — comma-separated keywords that trigger this FAQ (e.g., `price, cost, fee, charges`)
- **Category** — optional grouping label

Best practices

Write questions in natural language as customers would phrase them. Add multiple keyword variations to improve matching. For example, for a pricing FAQ, add keywords: `price, cost, fee, charges, rate, how much`.

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11. Conversation Flows

Navigate to **Automation → Flows** to build multi-step automated conversation sequences.

What are flows?

Flows are scripted conversation sequences that guide customers through a series of questions and responses. For example, a “Appointment Booking” flow might ask for the customer’s name, preferred date, and service type — collecting this information as a lead automatically.

Creating a flow

1. Click **Create Flow**
2. Give it a name and description
3. Add **steps** — each step has a message to send and optionally captures a variable (e.g., `{{name}}`, `{{date}}`)
4. Set the **trigger** — the keyword or event that starts this flow

Flow step types

Type	Description
Message	Send a text message
Question	Send a message and wait for a reply (saves reply as a variable)
Condition	Branch the flow based on the customer’s reply
End	Terminate the flow and optionally create a lead

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12. Broadcast Campaigns

Navigate to **Automation → Broadcast** to send bulk messages to your contacts.

> ***Important:*** *Meta requires all outbound broadcast messages to use pre-approved* ***Message Templates*** *(HSM). Create and get your templates approved first (see Section 13) before sending broadcasts.*

Creating a campaign

1. Click **Create Campaign**
2. Enter a campaign name and select the target audience (All Contacts, or filter by tag)
3. Write your message or select an approved template
4. Click **Send Now** or schedule for later

Campaign status

Status	Meaning
Draft	Not yet sent
Sending	Currently being delivered
Sent	Delivery complete
Failed	Delivery failed (check WhatsApp connection)

Recipient count

The campaign creation form shows the estimated recipient count based on your audience filter before you send.

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13. WhatsApp Templates

Navigate to **Platform → Templates** to manage your Meta-approved message templates.

Why templates are required

Meta's WhatsApp Business Policy requires that all **business-initiated** messages (broadcasts, follow-ups) use pre-approved templates. Customer-initiated conversations (replies) can use free-form text.

Template categories

Category	Use case
Marketing	Promotions, offers, announcements
Utility	Appointment reminders, order updates
Authentication	OTP codes, verification

Creating a template

1. Click **Create Template**
2. Enter a template name (lowercase, underscores only, e.g., `appointment_reminder`)
3. Select category and language
4. Write the body text. Use `{{1}}`, `{{2}}` etc. for variable placeholders
5. Add a header (text or image) and footer (optional)
6. Click **Submit for Approval**

Approval process

After submission, Meta reviews the template (typically within 24 hours). The status changes from **Pending** to **Approved** or **Rejected**. Rejected templates show the rejection reason.

Live preview

As you type the template body, a live WhatsApp-style phone preview updates in real time, showing exactly how the message will appear to recipients.

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14. Analytics & Reporting

Analytics page

Navigate to **Intelligence → Analytics** for a comprehensive view of your business metrics.

Available charts:

- 7-day message volume (sent vs. received)
- Lead conversion funnel (new → won)
- Top performing auto-reply rules
- Contact growth over time
- Response time distribution

Reporting page

Navigate to **Intelligence → Reporting** for advanced reporting features:

- **Shareable Report Links** — generate a public read-only URL for any report to share with stakeholders
- **PDF Export** — download any report as a formatted PDF
- **Team Comments** — add internal notes to reports for team collaboration
- **Scheduled Reports** — configure weekly or monthly email summaries sent automatically to the business owner

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15. AI Intelligence

Navigate to **Intelligence → AI Intelligence** for AI-powered insights and automation.

Anomaly Detection

The system monitors your lead volume, message volume, and response times. When a metric deviates significantly from the baseline (e.g., lead volume drops 50% vs. last week), an alert is raised with the severity level and recommended action.

SLO Thresholds

Define Service Level Objectives for your business:

- **Response Time SLO** — target time to first reply (e.g., under 5 minutes)
- **Lead Conversion SLO** — target conversion rate (e.g., 20% of leads to Won)
- **Resolution Time SLO** — target time to resolve a conversation

Breaches are highlighted with red badges and trigger notifications.

Lead Scoring

Click **Score All Leads** to run the AI scoring engine. Each lead receives a score from 0–100 based on:

- Recency of last interaction
- Number of messages exchanged
- Estimated deal value
- Tags and source

AI Reply Suggestions

In the Conversations page, the AI can suggest the best reply based on the conversation context. Click the suggestion to insert it into the message box.

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16. Embeddable Widget

Navigate to **Platform → Widget** to create a WhatsApp chat bubble for your website.

Creating a widget

1. Click **Create Widget**
2. Configure the appearance:
    - **Button Color** — matches your brand
    - **Position** — bottom-right or bottom-left

    - **Welcome Message** — shown when the bubble is expanded
    - **Pre-filled Message** — text pre-filled in WhatsApp when the customer clicks
3. A live **mobile phone mockup preview** shows exactly how the widget looks on a smartphone

Getting the embed code

Click **Get Embed Code** on any widget to copy the HTML snippet. Paste it before the `</body>` tag on your website.

```
<!-- WaLeadBot Chat Widget -->
<script>
  window.WaLeadBotConfig = {
    token: "your-widget-token",
    phone: "919876543210",
    message: "Hi, I'm interested in your services!"
  };
</script>
<script src="https://your-project.manus.space/widget.js" async></script>
```

How leads are captured

When a visitor clicks the chat bubble and sends a WhatsApp message, WaLeadBot automatically creates a contact and lead in your CRM, tagged with the source `widget`.

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17. Webhooks & Public API

Public API

WaLeadBot exposes a public REST API for external integrations:

Endpoint: `POST /api/public/leads`

Authentication: Pass your widget token in the `Authorization` header:

```
Authorization: Bearer your-widget-token
```

Request body:

```
{
  "name": "Rahul Sharma",
  "phone": "+919876543210",
  "email": "rahul@example.com",
  "source": "website-form",
  "notes": "Interested in 2BHK"
}
```

Response:

```
{
  "success": true,
  "leadId": 42,
  "contactId": 15
}
```

Outbound Webhooks

Navigate to **Platform → Webhooks** to configure outbound webhook endpoints. WaLeadBot fires events to your URL when key actions occur.

Available events:

Event	Triggered when
`lead.created`	A new lead is added to the CRM
`lead.updated`	A lead's status or details change
`message.received`	A new WhatsApp message arrives
`conversation.started`	A new conversation is opened
`broadcast.sent`	A broadcast campaign completes

Security: Each webhook endpoint has a secret key. WaLeadBot signs every request with an HMAC-SHA256 signature in the `X-WaLeadBot-Signature` header. Verify this in your server to ensure requests are genuine.

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18. Integrations

Navigate to **Platform → Integrations** to connect WaLeadBot with external tools.

Integration	What it does
Slack	Post new lead notifications to a Slack channel
Zapier	Connect to 5,000+ apps via Zapier webhooks
Jira	Create a Jira issue from any lead with one click
PagerDuty	Trigger an incident when an SLO is breached
Datadog	Push lead/message metrics to your Datadog dashboard

Each integration requires the corresponding API key or webhook URL. Keys are stored securely and never exposed in the frontend.

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19. Team Management

Navigate to **Account → Team** to manage who has access to your WaLeadBot workspace.

Roles

Role	Permissions
Owner	Full access, billing, delete workspace
Admin	Full access except billing and workspace deletion
Member	View and edit leads, contacts, conversations
Viewer	Read-only access to all data

Inviting a team member

1. Click **Invite Member**
2. Enter their email address and select a role
3. They receive an invitation email with a login link

Removing a member

Click the **Remove** button next to any team member. The owner cannot be removed.

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20. Billing & Subscription

Navigate to **Account → Billing** to manage your subscription plan.

Plans

Plan	Price	Contacts	Broadcasts/month	Team Members
Starter	₹299/month	500	1,000	1
Growth	₹599/month	2,000	5,000	5
Pro	₹999/month	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited

All plans include: Auto-replies, FAQ bot, Conversation flows, Lead CRM, Analytics, and WhatsApp API integration.

Upgrading

Click **Upgrade** on any plan card to be redirected to Stripe Checkout. Use test card `4242 4242 4242 4242` (any future expiry, any CVV) to test payments.

14-day free trial

New accounts automatically start on a 14-day free trial of the Pro plan. A countdown banner in the dashboard header shows the days remaining. After the trial, the account is downgraded to Starter unless a paid plan is activated.

Cancelling

Click **Cancel Subscription** on the Billing page. Your plan remains active until the end of the current billing period.

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21. Settings

Navigate to **Account → Settings** to configure your business profile and notification preferences.

Business Profile

Update your business name, industry, phone, address, website, and description. These details are used in the embeddable widget and email notifications.

Business Hours

Configure your operating hours per day of the week. Outside business hours, the auto-reply bot can send a custom “We’re closed” message.

Notifications

Toggle email notifications for:

- New lead captured
- New WhatsApp message received
- SLO breach alert
- Weekly summary report

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22. Admin Command Central

Navigate to **Account → Admin** (visible only to users with the Admin role).

The Admin Command Central provides a platform-wide view for managing all tenants:

- **Platform Stats** — total businesses, leads, messages, and monthly revenue
- **Tenant Health** — per-business WhatsApp connection status, message queue depth, and error rate
- **Coupon Engine** — create discount codes (percentage or fixed amount) for Stripe checkout
- **Pricing Management** — adjust plan limits (contact limits, broadcast limits) without redeployment
- **Audit Log** — full activity trail across all businesses with date and user filters

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23. Scalability & Agents

Navigate to **Platform → Scalability** to manage distributed WhatsApp agents.

What are agents?

For high-volume businesses, WaLeadBot supports multiple WhatsApp phone numbers (agents) under a single business account. Each agent handles a subset of conversations, enabling parallel processing.

Geo-routing

Assign contacts to agents based on phone number prefix (e.g., `+9180` → Mumbai agent, `+9144` → Chennai agent). This ensures customers are handled by the most relevant team.

Message queue dashboard

View the current message queue depth per agent, retry failed messages, and monitor delivery rates in real time.

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24. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I use WaLeadBot without the Meta Cloud API? No. WaLeadBot uses the official Meta Cloud API for all WhatsApp messaging. Unofficial WhatsApp Web scraping is against Meta's Terms of Service and is not supported.

Q: How do I get a permanent access token? In the Meta Developer Console, go to **Business Settings → System Users**, create a System User, assign it to your WhatsApp Business Account with full permissions, and generate a token. System User tokens do not expire.

Q: Why is my OTP not arriving? In development mode, OTPs are logged to the server console. For production, ensure `RESEND_API_KEY` (for email) or `MSG91_API_KEY` (for SMS/WhatsApp) is configured in Settings → Secrets.

Q: Can I import contacts from WhatsApp directly? WhatsApp does not provide an API to export contacts. Use the CSV import feature to bulk-import contacts from your phone's exported contact list or an existing CRM export.

Q: What happens if a customer sends a message outside business hours? If business hours are configured in Settings, the bot automatically sends your "outside

hours" message. Auto-reply rules and FAQ bot are still active 24/7 unless you configure them otherwise.

Q: How do I test broadcasts without sending to real customers? Create a test contact with your own WhatsApp number and tag it `test`. Create a broadcast targeting only the `test` tag to verify the message before sending to all contacts.

Q: Is customer data stored securely? All data is stored in a managed MySQL/TiDB database with encrypted connections. Webhook secrets are stored as hashed values. API keys are stored server-side and never exposed to the frontend.

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25. Secrets & API Keys Reference

The following environment variables must be configured in **Settings → Secrets** to enable full functionality:

Key	Service	Purpose
`RESEND_API_KEY`	Resend	Email OTP delivery
`RESEND_FROM_EMAIL`	Resend	Sender email address (e.g., `noreply@yourdomain.com`)
`MSG91_API_KEY`	MSG91	SMS and WhatsApp OTP delivery
`MSG91_SENDER_ID`	MSG91	SMS sender ID (6-character alphanumeric)
`MSG91_WHATSAPP_NUMBER`	MSG91	WhatsApp number for OTP delivery
`STRIPE_SECRET_KEY`	Stripe	Payment processing (server-side)
`STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET`	Stripe	Webhook signature verification
`VITE_STRIPE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY`	Stripe	Payment processing (client-side)

All keys are optional — the platform runs in demo/development mode without them, with graceful fallbacks (OTPs logged to console, payments disabled).

Quick Start Checklist

Use this checklist to go live in under 30 minutes:

- [ ] Sign up with your email and verify OTP
- [ ] Complete the onboarding wizard (business profile + WhatsApp connection)
- [ ] Add 5–10 FAQ entries for your most common questions
- [ ] Create a welcome auto-reply (trigger: Any Message, priority: 99)
- [ ] Import your existing contacts via CSV
- [ ] Add your team members
- [ ] Configure your embeddable widget and paste it on your website
- [ ] Create your first broadcast campaign
- [ ] Set up your Stripe billing to activate a paid plan
- [ ] Configure Resend/MSG91 API keys for production OTP delivery

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WaLeadBot is built for Indian SMBs. For support, contact your administrator or refer to the in-app help tooltips.